

AY25 PROGRAM ASSESSMENT REPORT

v2026.1

Tracking Data

CIM code (e.g., ME-CM)	BS-PPOL
Program Name	BS in Public Policy
Assessment Year	2024-25
Program Assessment Coordinator	Saran Ghatak
Year of Current Assessment Plan	1
No Assessment This Year per Plan	☐
LO(s) Assessed	1
Presented at program authority meeting date: <i>Please attach minutes</i>	9/12/2025

Methodology

For each LO and artifact assessed, please describe methodology used, and attach (as supplemental files during report submission) or insert here the rubric used. At minimum this should contain:

- a description of how the artifact is concordant with the LO
- a rubric describing the method used to place individual student in at least 3 assessment categories; {**D** Does not meet expectations, **M** Meets expectations *M*, **P** Proficient}

The BS in Public Policy degree began admitting students in AY 2024-25. The assessment plan for this year included assessment of LO 1 : “Students will demonstrate understanding of major concepts and theoretical principles in the field.”

Student assignments were collected as artifacts from declared majors in the core courses: SSCI 106 Introduction to Public Policy, SSCI 209 Social Science Research Methods, and SSCI 486 Program Evaluation. There were 4 assignments in total. This is consistent with overall enrollment trends in social science majors.

The artifacts were assessed by three faculty members: Saran Ghatak, Yuri Mansury, and Chris Meyer on September 8, 2025. The artifacts were graded on a six-point scale: 1-2 denoted poor/ does not meet expectations (D), 3-4 denoted average (M), 5-6 denoted proficient (P) performance. The 6-point scale was chosen to allow for high-low refinement (high-end of average or low-end of average, for example). The faculty had previously done assessment, and their grading criterion was already normed.

Results

Artifact samples

Attach artifact samples. You can paste them in here if feasible, attach them to the end of this report, or submit them as supplemental files when submitting your reports. For data sets with ≤ 10 students, provide 1 in each category, D,M,P, (unless the category is empty, if so state that). For programs with ≤ 20 , provide 2. For other programs provide 3. Please redact any personally identifiable information, PII (which includes names and A#s). Please convert your documents to PDFs.

Please use the following naming convention for your artifact files: **AY25_CIM-CODE_Name of Artifact.pdf**.

Data table

For each LO and provide a table pasted in from the [provided template](#) placing each student into the assessment categories (minimally {D, M, P}). Please redact any personally identifiable information, PII (including names or A#s) from this report. Provide a summary graph from the template presenting this distribution. You should also present additional analysis as deemed appropriate by the results seen, and the needs of the program.

Learning Outcome

Score

"Students will demonstrate understanding of major concepts and theoretical principles in the field."	Average: 4.18 Standard Deviation: .372678
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Description of findings

Summarize the discussion that occurred within the program authority when this was presented. Provide a short narrative interpreting the findings. Are there any areas of concern?

This was a very small population of artifacts given the low number of students enrolled in the core courses in the first year of the program.

We discussed the following points:

1. The student assignments show that the courses met the learning objective slightly above the average level. While this demonstrated a degree of success, it leaves room for future improvement.
2. The discussion focused on the potential of changing the assessment plan to assess all learning objectives at the same time as this would also allow us to assess a larger and more representative sample.

Continuous Improvement, CI, plans

The purpose of assessment is to improve the quality of our educational programs. The most important part of the assessment cycle is how we use the data to improve our programs. Examine the data provided above describing student achievement, consider the root cause of any deficits, and if areas for possible improvement emerge, describe plans to achieve this improvement.

The data shows that learning objectives were met above the average level. Once we have assessed all four learning objectives of the program, we will devise a plan for improvement.

Prior CI plan impact

Also, please refer to the previous assessment report for the LOs assessed. Were any CI plans recommended? Were they implemented? Did the plans work (were improvements seen in this cycle)?

☒ no previous CI plans available

Public Policy is a new program which began admitting its first students in the year of assessment. There is no CI plan available yet.

This cycle's CI plan

Describe any CI plans developed from this cycle's data, with

- Specific curricular or instructional changes in response to this assessment data,
- A timeline for implementation,
- As well a description of who will participate in and manage these plans

☐ After consideration and presentation to the program authority, no CI plans are recommended.